HOORVIA — STEAK DONENESS CHART: INTERNAL TEMPS, PULL TEMPS & TOUCH TEST

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet • Rare to Well-Done • Pull vs Final Carryover Temps • US Letter (8.5" × 11")

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■ STEAK DONENESS LEVELS: PULL TEMP VS. FINAL TARGET TEMP

Doneness Level	Pull From Heat At	Final Rested Temp	Visual Center Description	Mouthfeel & Juiciness
Blue / Extra-Rare	110°F / 43°C	115°F / 46°C	Deep purple-red; cool center	Very soft, spongy, raw-like core
Rare	120°F / 49°C	125°F / 52°C	Bright ruby red across 75% of center	Very tender, abundant red juices
Medium-Rare (Chef Standard)	130°F / 54°C	135°F / 57°C	Warm red center with pink halo	Buttery, maximum flavor & melted fat
Medium	140°F / 60°C	145°F / 63°C (USDA)	Rose pink throughout center	Firm bite, moderately juicy
Medium-Well	150°F / 66°C	155°F / 68°C	Thin sliver of light pink in middle	Chewy, noticeably drier
Well-Done	155°F / 68°C	160°F+ / 71°C+	100% brown edge-to-edge; zero pink	Firm, dense, minimal natural moisture

■ BEST DONENESS LEVEL BY STEAK CUT (FAT VS. LEAN MUSCLE)

Steak Cut	Marbling / Fat Profile	Ideal Doneness Target	Ideal Pull Temp	Why This Temp Works Best
Filet Mignon (Tenderloin)	Very Lean (Minimal fat)	Rare to Medium-Rare	122°F–128°F	No marbling to protect against drying past 135°F
Ribeye / Tomahawk	Heavy Intramuscular Fat	Medium-Rare to Medium	132°F–137°F	Needs 135°F+ to fully render thick eye fat
New York Strip (Strip Loin)	Moderate Marbling + Rim	Medium-Rare	128°F–132°F	Balances beefy chew with tender interior
Porterhouse / T-Bone	Dual Cut (Filet + Strip)	Medium-Rare	125°F (Filet side)	Keep filet side cooler away from direct burner
Flank / Skirt / Hanger	Lean with Long Grain	Medium-Rare (Max)	128°F–130°F	Becomes tough if cooked past 140°F; slice thin
Top Sirloin / Picanha	Lean Muscle + Fat Cap	Medium-Rare	128°F–131°F	Score fat cap first; rest 8 minutes before slicing

■ CAST-IRON & GRILL SEARING TIMING (1.25-INCH THICK STEAK AT HIGH HEAT)

Target Doneness	Total Cook Time	Flip Method	Butter Baste (Arrosé) Window	Mandatory Rest
Rare (125°F Final)	5 – 6 minutes	Flip every 60 sec	Last 60 sec w/ butter, garlic & thyme	5 minutes
Medium-Rare (135°F Final)	7 – 8 minutes	Flip every 60 sec	Last 90 sec w/ foaming herb butter	6–8 minutes
Medium (145°F Final)	9 – 10 minutes	Flip every 90 sec	Last 2 min; lower heat to medium	6–8 minutes
Reverse Sear (1.75"+ Thick)	25 min @ 250°F Oven	Sear 60 sec/side	Pull from oven at 115°F, sear to 130°F	No rest needed!

CHEF'S PRO TIP: Why flipping every 60 seconds beats flipping only once: America's Test Kitchen proved that flipping a steak every minute prevents heat from building up on one side, eliminating the grey overcooked band under the crust and cooking 30% faster!
USDA SAFE MINIMUM INTERNAL TEMPS: All Poultry: 165°F (74°C) • Ground Beef/Pork: 160°F (71°C) • Whole Steaks, Chops, Roasts & Fish: 145°F (63°C) + 3-Min Rest

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